Fertilisers

☞ **1** Circle the correctly spelled word in each pair.

Fertilisers are chemicals/chemcials used to increase crop yield by putting essential eliments/elements such as phosphorus and potassium/potasium back into the soil. They also provide nitrogen, which increases plant growth. Fertilyzers/Fertilisers dissolve in water and are then absorbed by the plant. Fertilisers are salts that are made by neutralising different acids and bases.

The problem with fertilisers is that they can pollute/polute water supplies and cause the growth of algae/algee in waterways. This leads to a process called **eutrophication**. Lakes and rivers become 'dead' due to pollution from fertilisers.

2 What is the chemical symbol for each of the following essential elements?

nitrogen _____ phosphorus _____ potassium _____

3 The table below lists some common fertilisers. Identify the essential elements in each fertiliser that help increase crop yield. The first one has been done for you.

ammonium nitrate	$NH_4 NO_3$	nitrogen
ammonium sulfate	$(NH_4)_2SO_4$	
ammonium phosphate	$(NH_4)_3PO_4$	
potassium nitrate	KNO_3	

4 Number the steps below to show the order they occur in process of eutrophication.

_____ Other plants die.

_____ Fertilisers run off into the waterways.

_____ Algal bloom appears.

_____ Most organisms in the water die.

_____ Increase in amount of nitrate or phosphate in the water.

_____ Extra algae blocks off light to other plants.

_____ Bacteria feed on dead plants and multiply, using up oxygen in the water.

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